RESUF AHMED

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Postdoctoral Fellow, Stanford King Center on Global Development, Stanford University
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CURRENT POSITION

Postdoctoral Fellow *January 2026 -*
Stanford University

EDUCATION

PhD Economics *2020 - 2025*
HEC Lausanne, University of Lausanne
Advisors: Dominic Rohner and Ekaterina Zhuravskaya

MA Economics *2018 - 2020*
Paris School of Economics

BA Economics *2014 - 2017*
University of Delhi

RESEARCH

Field: Development Economics, Political Economics, Cultural Economics

Working Papers

From Reservation to Transformation: The Socioeconomic Impact of Political Quotas

Ancient Epics in the Television Age: Religious Identity and the Rise of Hindu Nationalism in India (with Dean Yang, Alessandro Saia, Akhila Kovvuri and Paul Brimble) (*NBER WP 33417*) *Under Review*

Leader Marches as an Opposition Electoral Strategy (with Feyaad Allie) *Under Review*

Technology and the Production of Justice: System-Wide Effects of Indonesia's E-Court Reform (with Sultan Mehmood and Alexandra Filimonova) *Under Review*

Work in Progress

Power-sharing, Segregation and Conflict (with Ekaterina Zhuravskaya, Saumitra Jha, Dominic Rohner, and Alessandro Saia)

Debunking Myths: Ancestral Narratives and Intergroup Cooperation in India (with Riccardo Ghidoni, Mariapia Mendola, Stefano Piasenti and Alessandro Saia)

Press & Public Engagement

Inside Modi's "Cockroach" Crackdown, October 2026, *Journal of Democracy* (Online Exclusive)
Can digitising courts speed up justice without cutting corners?, September 2026, *VoxDev*
The Sunday morning broadcast that changed Indian democracy, March 2026, *VoxDev*
Decoding Bharat Jodo Yatra's impact on Karnataka Elections, May 2023, *Hindustan Times*
How the Ramayan TV Show Helped Shape a Singular Nationwide Hindu Identity, February 2025, *The Hindu (coverage)*

CONFERENCES

** (Presentation by co-author)*

2026 NBER Workshop on Development Economics and Networks (Cambridge, MA; scheduled)

2025 ISI-Delhi Conference on Economic Growth and Development, BSE Summer Forum Political Economy*, ECINEQ (World Bank and GWU), Tokyo Conference on Institutions, Law and Development (GRIPS), European Meeting on the Political Economy of South Asia (Naples), BREAD (Princeton)*

2024 ISI-Delhi Conference on Economic Growth and Development, Lewis Lab Workshop (Manchester), Paris School of Economics (May and November), ASREC Europe, ACES Summer School (Hong Kong), IRES Graduate Workshop (Los Angeles), ASREC (Chapman)

2023 ISI-Delhi Conference on Economic Growth and Development, Delhi School of Economics, ASREC Workshop (Harvard), Brown University

2022 ISI-Delhi Conference on Economic Growth and Development, DSE Winter School, Z-PESS (ETH Zurich), ISI Delhi, SERI Workshop (ISB Hyderabad), Applied Economics Lunch (PSE), ASREC (online), University of Lausanne

2021 University of Zurich

TEACHING

Development Economics Fall 2025, 2024, 2023, 2022

MSc Economics, University of Lausanne

Economic Analysis and Communication Fall 2024, 2023, 2022, 2021

MSc Economics, University of Lausanne

Statistics and Econometrics I Fall 2024, 2023, 2022, 2021

BSc Economics, University of Lausanne

AWARDS & HONOURS

Virginia Gray Graduate Student Research Award 2024 by the American Political Science Association
Doctoral Mobility Fellowship by the University of Lausanne - 30,000 USD
PhD Scholarship by the University of Lausanne for the year 2020 - 2025
PPD Grant 2019 by the Paris School of Economics
Charpak BCS Scholarship (Bourse de Couverture Sociale) by the Government of France. 2018-2020
Young India Fellowship 2017 by the Ashoka University - 700,000 INR (Declined)

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Referee: *World Development*

SKILLS

Python, QGIS, STATA and R

Field Visits

Karnataka, India (January 2024)
Uttar Pradesh, India (March-May, 2025)